

Advanced SEO Course 2025

Class 1

Transcript :

Introduction: The State of SEO in 2025

- **[00:00]** 2025 is a strange year for SEOs. While people have been predicting the "death of SEO" for 26 years, new terms like **AIO, AEO, GEO, and LLMO** are now creating real confusion.
 - **[00:22]** Newcomers are unsure if they should learn SEO, while veterans are confused about which new acronym to focus on. Even Google adds to the fire by giving vague "It depends" answers to most questions.
 - **[00:48]** This course is designed to clear that confusion. It is a complete SEO course for the AI era, covering how to rank on Google and ChatGPT, and how to use AI for content, audits, and keyword research.
 - **[01:20] Course Details:** It is free and will last 4–5 months. Expect 2–3 lectures per week. There will be a members-only live doubt-clearing session every Sunday (Membership fee: ₹29).
 - **[03:24] About the Instructor:** Amit Tiwari is a Technical SEO expert with 14 years of experience, having navigated major updates like Penguin, Panda, and the current AI shift.
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What is SEO (Search Engine Optimization)?

- **[04:13]** Technically, it should be called **OSE (Optimization for Search Engines)** because we don't optimize the search engine itself; we optimize our web pages *for* it.

The 5 Steps of a Search Engine

1. **Discovery:** The search engine finds your URL (typically via Sitemaps).
 2. **Crawling:** Automated bots visit and read your pages.
 3. **Rendering:** The technical process where the bot "sees" or visualizes the website like a browser.
 4. **Indexing:** Saving the processed information into a massive database.
 5. **Ranking:** Displaying the most relevant information to the user in search results.
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Key Responsibilities of an SEO

- **Content Creation:** Moving beyond just service pages to provide actual value to the user.
 - **Analytics:** Tracking data to understand where traffic is coming from and why.
 - **Reporting:** Proving the results and ROI of your work to the client.
 - **SEO vs. PPC:** Unlike PPC (ads), which focuses only on the campaign, an SEO is responsible for the overall maintenance, health, and indexability of the website.
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Decoding the New Acronyms

- **AIO (AI Optimization):** Considered a "wrong term" for marketers because we don't optimize AI; we optimize for searches powered by AI.
 - **AEO (Answer Engine Optimization):** A sensible term because platforms like ChatGPT provide direct answers rather than just links.
 - **GEO (Generative Engine Optimization):** The most trending term right now, focusing on Generative AI results.
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Is GEO actually different from SEO?

While industry publications (like Search Engine Land) highlight specific pillars of GEO, Amit argues these have always been part of **Traditional SEO**:

- **Response Generation:** Essentially creating summaries (like TL;DR sections).
- **Contextualization:** Tailoring content to specific user needs.
- **Information Synthesis:** Gathering data from multiple sources (Silo structures).
- **User Intent:** Understanding if a user wants to buy (Commercial) or learn (Informational).
- **Other Factors:** Algorithmic adaptation, content formatting, research-driven strategies, and performance tracking are all existing SEO practices.

1. What Needs to Be Done (The 8 Duties of an SEO)

According to the source, the job of an SEO is not just ranking; it involves a comprehensive 8-step process. The first five steps mirror the function of a search engine, followed by three administrative duties,

1. Discovery: Ensure the search engine knows your pages exist.

2. Crawling: Ensure the search engine bot can visit and access your pages.

3. Rendering: Ensure the bot can "read" and visualize the website code (especially for JavaScript sites).

4. Indexing: Convince the search engine to save a copy of your page in its database.

5. Ranking: Optimize the page so it appears for specific user queries.

6. Content Creation: Create useful content that answers user questions.

7. Analytics: Collect and analyze traffic data to refine strategies.

8. Reporting: Prove the value of the work to the client.

2. How To Do It (Implementation Strategy)

Optimizing for the Technical Steps

- **For Discovery:** You must provide a URL list to Google, usually through a Sitemap, and ensure pages are internally connected so Google can find them,.
- **For Crawling:** You must check that your hosting/server is not slow and does not block Google's bots. You need to ensure all doors are open for the bot to enter.
- **For Rendering:** You must test whether the Google bot can actually see the content on your page, particularly if the design uses complex code like JavaScript. If the bot cannot render the page, it assumes the page is empty.
- **For Indexing:** You must ensure the content is valuable enough for Google to store. If a page isn't indexed, you must identify the reason, add value to the page, and request indexing again. Conversely, you should hide non-useful pages from bots to save resources.
- **For Ranking:** You must prove to Google that your page provides the best answer for a user's query.

Handling Content and Analytics

- **Content:** Do not rely solely on blog posts. Create content based on the actual services and products, ensuring it addresses specific user queries rather than just listing features,. Even if AI writes the content, a human (SEO) must approve and manage it.
 - **Analytics:** specific keywords users use to find you. Remove or improve keywords that are irrelevant (e.g., ranking for "comb" when you sell something else).
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3. Common Mistakes and Solutions

Mistake 1: Focusing only on Ranking

- **The Error:** Many believe SEOs only rank websites overnight. Some courses teach SEO backward, starting with ranking and checking indexing only if ranking fails.

- **The Solution:** Follow the logical order:

Discovery → Crawling → Rendering → Indexing → Ranking. If a step is missed (e.g., the page isn't indexed), ranking is impossible,.

Mistake 2: Confusing SEO with PPC (Pay-Per-Click)

- **The Error:** Expecting PPC executives to fix website health issues like crawling or indexing.
- **The Solution:** Understand that PPC ads do not require a healthy, indexable website to run (they can run on external links), whereas SEOs care for the overall health of the website,.

Mistake 3: Falling for Buzzwords (AIO, LLMO, GEO)

- **The Error:** Beginners get confused by new terms like AIO (Artificial Intelligence Optimization) or GEO (Generative Engine Optimization), thinking they need to learn entirely new skills,.
- **The Solution:** Recognize that "AIO" is a misnomer because marketers optimize for search engines, not the AI technology itself. Understand that GEO is essentially SEO. The strategies claimed by GEO (summaries, user intent, researching) are standard practices SEOs have been doing for years,.

Mistake 4: Blog Post Obsession

- **The Error:** Business owners often think creating blog posts is the only way to rank.
- **The Solution:** Forget the idea that SEO equals blog posts; focus on service pages and intent-based content.

4. Do's and Don'ts

Do's

- Do adopt the acronym "OSE": Ideally, view the job as "Optimization for Search Engines" rather than Search Engine Optimization to understand the workflow better.
- Do analyze User Intent: Understand if a user wants information, a transaction, or navigation (commercial vs. informational intent).
- Do validate AI Content: You can use AI for content, but you must oversee and approve it.
- Do maintain Reporting: Always create reports for clients because when business is down, the marketing person is the first to be blamed.
- Do keep learning: The industry updates frequently (sometimes every 2.5 hours), so continuous adaptation is part of the job.

Don'ts

- Don't use the term "AIO": It is conceptually incorrect for marketers.
 - Don't assume summaries are new: Using summaries (a "GEO" tactic) is a classic SEO technique for "Too Long; Didn't Read" optimization,.
 - Don't ignore Rendering: Just because you can see the website with your eyes doesn't mean the bot can see it; ignoring this leads to de-indexing,.
 - Don't ignore the "Seeds": Do not skip the foundational theory (the "seeds") just to get quick results (the "fruits"); understanding the base is essential.
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Class 2

Transcript :

Introduction: Why Understanding the "How" Matters

- [\[00:00\]](#) This class covers how search engines work, specifically Google's internal architecture and the 10 methods Google uses to discover URLs.
 - [\[00:56\]](#) Many SEOs fear that ChatGPT or Perplexity will replace Google. Understanding how a Search Engine (which works on indexing) differs from an LLM (which works on prediction) is the key to removing that fear.
 - [\[01:53\]](#) This content is based on 14 years of learning and Google's own research papers, much of which is usually only found in private paid courses.
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1. The Simple Model of a Search Engine [\[03:21\]](#)

A basic search engine consists of five main nodes:

1. **The Web (Internet):** The source of all data.
 2. **Crawler:** A program (like Googlebot) that visits websites and downloads data.
 3. **Indexer:** A system that "digests" and processes the data collected by the crawler.
 4. **Index:** The storage warehouse where processed data is saved.
 5. **Query Engine & Interface:** The bridge between the user and the index. When a user types a query, the Query Engine retrieves relevant info from the Index and displays it on the Interface.
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2. Google's Advanced Architecture [08:01]

Google's system is far more complex, divided into four functional stages: **Acquisition, Indexing, Retrieval, and Ranking.**

A. Acquisition (Finding & Storing Data)

- **URL Server [10:19]:** Maintains a massive list of billions of URLs. It removes duplicates and feeds URLs to the crawler in batches based on priority and urgency (e.g., URLs submitted via Search Console are prioritized).
- **Crawler [11:43]:** Written in C++, its only job is to download HTML, images, and videos. It uses a "headless" version of Chrome to render pages as a human would.
- **Store Server [12:46]:** Compresses the downloaded data and assigns it an internal ID.
- **Repository [13:33]:** A massive backup storage containing a "carbon copy" of the entire internet.

B. Indexing (Processing Data)

- **Indexer [14:13]:** Unpacks data from the Repository and performs two tasks:
 1. **Hit Generation:** Breaks text into "Word IDs." Each "Hit" contains the word, its ID, position, font size, and capitalization.
 2. **Link Extraction:** Extracts every link and its associated anchor text from the HTML.
- **Lexicon [27:02]:** A system that manages the Word IDs and vocabulary.
- **Barrels [27:44]:** Creates a "Forward Index" (mapping a Document ID to all the Word IDs it contains).
- **Sorter [28:39]:** Flips the Forward Index into an "**Inverted Index**" (mapping a Word ID to all the Document IDs that contain it). This is what makes Google searches so fast.

C. Link Analysis

- **Anchor System [17:01]:** Saves the anchor text of extracted links.
- **URL Resolver [17:25]:** Converts "Relative URLs" (e.g., /page1) into "Absolute URLs" (e.g., https://example.com/page1) and strips Document IDs to assign them to their proper domains.
- **Links & PageRank [21:30]:** The Links system maps out which pages link to each other. This map is then used by the **PageRank** algorithm to calculate the "weight" or authority of each page.

D. Retrieval & Ranking [29:13]

- **The Searcher (Front-end):** When you search, Google doesn't show a pre-made list. It retrieves about 10 relevant links in real-time.
- **Real-time Ranking:** The final order (Position 1 vs. Position 10) is decided in milliseconds right when you hit "search," based on PageRank and hundreds of other ranking signals.

3. The 10 Methods of URL Discovery [32:53]

How does Google find your page even if you don't build links?

1. **Sitemaps [33:58]**: An XML or TXT list of your pages.
2. **Internal Links**: Links within your own website.
3. **External Links**: Backlinks from other websites.
4. **Random Guessing [35:32]**: If Google sees page-121 and page-123, it will guess and try to crawl page-122.
5. **Server Logs [36:24]**: If your server logs are public, Googlebot can find URLs visited by internal users.
6. **Chrome Data [37:14]**: If you type a new URL into the Chrome browser, Google may use that data to discover and crawl the site.
7. **Domain Registrars [38:00]**: Google can identify newly registered domains.
8. **RSS/Atom Feeds [38:24]**: Crawling updates via site feeds.
9. **Google Search Console (GSC) [38:39]**: Direct submission via the "URL Inspection" tool.
10. **JS Rendering [39:04]**: Finding URLs hidden inside JavaScript code that only appear after the code is executed.

1.What Needs to Be Done (The System Workflow)

To function as a search engine, the system must process information through distinct stages: Acquisition, Indexing, Retrieval, and Ranking.

- **URL Management**: A system must exist to manage millions of URLs. The URL Server maintains lists of URLs, removes duplicates, and feeds them to crawlers in batches based on importance.
- **Acquisition (Crawling)**: The system must visit websites and download their data. Crawlers (like Googlebot) visit URLs, download HTML and assets (images/videos), and render the page using a headless version of Chrome.
- **Storage**: The downloaded data must be saved. The Store Server compresses the content and assigns it an internal ID. This is saved in a Repository, which acts as a massive backup drive containing a snapshot of the internet.
- **Indexing**: The stored data must be unpacked and processed. The Indexer digests the data, breaking down text into small words and extracting links.
- **Mapping**: The system must map the relationship between pages. A Links system creates a map of which pages link to which, feeding data to the PageRank algorithm to calculate weight.

2. How to Do It (Technical Execution)

This section details the specific mechanisms Google uses to execute the workflow described above.

A. Processing Content (Lexicon and Hits)

- Hit Generation: The Indexer breaks content down into words. The Lexicon system assigns a unique "Word ID" to every word.
- Creating Hits: A "HIT" is created containing the Word ID, the word itself, and its attributes (font size, color, position, capitalization).

B. Organizing the Index (Barrels and Sorters)

- Forward Index (Barrels): The system mixes Document IDs with the Word IDs found within that document to create "Barrels" (a forward index).
- Inverted Index (Sorter): A Sorter reverses the forward index. It maps Word IDs to Document IDs, allowing the system to know which documents contain a specific word.

C. Handling URLs (The URL Resolver)

- Normalization: The URL Resolver converts relative URLs (e.g., [/page1](#)) found during crawling into absolute URLs (e.g., <https://example.com/page1>).
- ID Stripping: It strips the Document ID associated with the source repository file so the link is assigned to its own correct domain/ID.

D. Discovery (Finding URLs)

The system discovers URLs through 10 specific methods, not just sitemaps. These include:

1. Sitemaps: Lists of URLs provided by site owners.
2. Internal Links: Links from one page to another on the same site.
3. External Links: Links from other websites.
4. Random Guessing: If the crawler sees [page1](#) and [page3](#), it may guess [page2](#) exists.
5. Server/Error Logs: Crawlers may check open server logs for URLs.
6. Chrome Usage: New websites visited in Chrome may be indexed.
7. Domain Registration: Google monitors new domain purchases.
8. RSS Feeds: URLs appearing in feeds.
9. GSC Submission: Submitting URLs in Google Search Console sends them directly to the URL Server.
10. JS Rendering: Rendering JavaScript to find links.

3. Do's and Don'ts (Best Practices for SEOs)

Do's

- Do Understand the Architecture: You must understand how search engines work (vs. LLMs) to overcome the fear of updates and AI replacement.
- Do Use Absolute URLs: Always use complete absolute URLs (e.g., <https://example.com/image.jpg>) rather than relative URLs. This saves Google's URL Resolver a step, preserving resources for your site.
- Do Utilize Internal Linking: When you link internally, the URL is sent to the Document Index and back to the URL Server queue, ensuring the linked page is crawled again.
- Do Practice: You must make notes and practice the course material; simply watching is not enough.

Don'ts

- Don't Fear LLMs: Do not think ChatGPT will replace Google immediately; they work in opposite ways (Google works via indexing/retrieval; LLMs work differently).
- Don't Use Relative URLs: WordPress may suggest relative paths, but you should avoid them to ensure efficient crawling.
- Don't Obsess Over 200 Signals: Do not believe there are exactly 200 ranking signals you must track; focus on the 5-6 key signals relevant to your work.
- Don't Panic Over "Indexing": Do not assume a lack of immediate indexing means failure; the process involves many steps (Crawler -> Store -> Repository -> Indexer -> URL Resolver).

4. Common Mistakes and Solutions

Mistake 1: Thinking the Crawler "Reads" Content

- The Error: Believing the crawler understands the page text.
- The Reality: The crawler's *only* job is to visit the URL, download the HTML/assets, and save them. It does not read, understand, or rank content.
- Solution: Understand that "understanding" happens later in the Indexer and Lexicon stages.

Mistake 2: Thinking Indexing is Instant

- The Error: Expecting a page to appear in search results immediately after publishing or submitting to GSC.

- The Reality: The data must travel from the Crawler to the Store Server, to the Repository, to the Indexer, to the URL Resolver, and finally to the Document Index.
- Solution: Be patient with the scheduling and processing time.

Mistake 3: Believing Ranking Happens Before Retrieval

- The Error: Thinking Google keeps a pre-ranked list of pages.
- The Reality: Google retrieves a set of relevant links first. Ranking is a real-time process that decides the order of those links only when the user executes the query.
- Solution: Focus on providing clear signals (Word IDs, Hits) that match user queries to ensure retrieval, then optimize for ranking signals like PageRank.

Mistake 4: Relying Solely on Sitemaps

- The Error: Thinking Google only finds pages if they are in the XML sitemap.
- The Reality: Google uses 10 different methods to discover URLs, including inspecting server logs and random guessing.
- Solution: If you want a page to remain secret, you must explicitly `noindex` it; simply removing it from the sitemap is not enough.

Class 3

Transcript :

Core Concepts of LLMs

- **Large Language Models (LLMs):** Despite the name, computers don't understand language; they understand numbers. LLMs use a "look-up table" to convert words into numbers (tokens), perform calculations, and then convert the numerical output back into human-readable text [02:08].
- **Training Process:**
 - * **Pre-training:** Predicting the next word based on massive datasets [05:53].
 - **Supervised Fine-Tuning (SFT):** Training the model to answer specific questions [22:23].
 - **Reinforcement Learning from Human Feedback (RLHF):** Implementing safety guidelines and human-aligned responses [23:25].
- **Transformers:** A breakthrough by Google (the "Attention is All You Need" paper) that allowed models to use context to predict words more efficiently, significantly reducing the required computing power [15:53].

Vectors and Vector Embeddings

- **Vectors:** These convert concepts or items into mathematical scores based on their properties (e.g., comparing a "dentist" and a "doctor" based on medical knowledge vs. farming knowledge) [25:43].
- **Vector Embeddings:** Multi-dimensional representations of data that allow AI to see how "close" or related two concepts are, which is the foundation of **Semantic SEO** and recommendation algorithms [32:18].

RAG (Retrieval-Augmented Generation)

- **How it Works:** RAG systems like **Perplexity** don't just rely on pre-trained data. They break down queries into embeddings, search their own vector databases or perform real-time web searches, and then use an LLM to synthesize an answer from those results [35:18].
- **Real-time Search:** These systems provide more up-to-date information than standard LLMs by integrating live search data [36:32].

SEO Implications

- To optimize for AI search engines, you must understand how these systems "chunk" data and create embeddings.

- The video concludes by emphasizing that mastering tools like **Google Search Console** is essential for any SEO professional, as it remains the primary data source for website performance [47:08].

Do's and Don'ts

Do's

- **Attend previous classes:** You must watch the previous two classes before this one to fully understand the concepts.
- **Treat LLMs as "Large Number Models":** Understand that computers process numbers, not language. They convert words into numbers using a look-up table to perform calculations,.
- **Note down doubts:** Write down all questions and doubts during the class to ask in the live doubt session on Sunday,.
- **Complete the assignment:** After the class, go to the YouTube "Post" section to find and solve the assignment based on the day's learning.

Don'ts

- **Do not miss classes:** Students who miss classes will not be able to take full advantage of the course.
 - **Do not assume computers "understand" language:** It is a misconception that LLMs understand human language; they only understand patterns and numbers,.
 - **Do not confuse the application with the model:** Do not treat ChatGPT and LLMs as the same thing. ChatGPT is a chatbot application (a wrapper), whereas GPT-4 or GPT-5 are the actual Large Language Models,.
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What Needs to be Done

For the Student (Coursework):

- **Test your retention:** You need to solve the problems provided in the assignment to check if you have retained the information or need to re-watch the class.
- **Join the Membership:** To access the live doubt classes and assignments, you need to join the channel membership.

For the SEO Professional (Semantic SEO):

- **Understand Vector Embeddings:** You need to learn how search engines and AI models divide objects (or keywords) based on properties and scores to understand "closeness" or relevance,.
- **Optimize for Embeddings:** The goal is to convert user queries and web pages into vectors and optimize them so they are mathematically "close" in the multi-dimensional space. This process is called Semantic SEO.

- **Analyze User Intent for Perplexity:** Determine if your audience prefers the direct answers provided by RAG systems like Perplexity (e.g., makeup tips) or if they prefer deep research (e.g., neuroscientists).
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How to Do It

How LLMs Work (The Process):

- **Prediction:** LLMs function as prediction engines. When given a prompt, they predict the next word based on probability calculations derived from massive training data,.
- **Training Phases:**
 1. Pre-training: The model learns to predict words and sets its internal "dials" (connections).
 2. SFT (Supervised Fine Tuning): The model is fed pairs of questions and answers so it learns *how* to answer queries rather than just guessing random words,.
 3. RLHF (Reinforced Learning from Human Feedback): Safety settings are applied so the model knows which questions *not* to answer (e.g., harmful content),.
- **Using Transformers:** Instead of calculating every word equally, use the "Attention" mechanism (introduced by Google) to understand context (e.g., knowing "Ram" refers to a deity vs. computer memory based on the surrounding words),.

How RAG/Perplexity Works:

- **Vector Database:** Content is broken into chunks, converted into embeddings, and stored in a database,.
 - **Retrieval:** When a user asks a question, the system searches its vector database for relevant info *and* performs a live web search (using engines like Google or Bing),.
 - **Generation:** The retrieved data and the user query are sent to an LLM, which combines them to generate a final answer.
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Common Mistakes and Solutions

Mistake 1: Believing prompts generate instant answers.

- The Error: Thinking that as soon as you hit enter, ChatGPT gets the full answer and displays it.
- The Reality: The model writes word by word. It uses the part of the answer it just generated as part of the prompt for the *next* word.

Mistake 2: Thinking Perplexity has its own web index.

- The Error: Assuming Perplexity crawls the entire web like Google to answer questions.

- The Solution: Understand that Perplexity (and similar RAG systems) likely relies on existing search engine APIs (like Google, Bing, or specialized APIs) to fetch live results, which are then processed by an LLM,.

Mistake 3: Thinking probability is ever 0% or 100%.

- The Error: Assuming a word *cannot* follow another word.
- The Solution: In LLM probability calculations, nothing is ever 0 or 1. There is always a non-zero chance (e.g., 0.001) that a word might appear, even by mistake.

Mistake 4: Finding the technical concepts too difficult.

- The Error: Getting overwhelmed by concepts like vectors, N-grams, or 2.5 billion calculations.
- The Solution: View the content as a "high-level overview" rather than a computer science degree. If it is difficult, watch the class 2-3 times to grasp the concept, as understanding this is the "first step" toward automation and advanced SEO.

Class 4

Transcript :

Introduction to Google Search Console

Google Search Console is the tool that makes your website and Google friends with each other, acting as a mediator between the two. It allows you to know the problems your website has and the expectations or complaints Google has regarding your site. It is intended to smooth out the connection because Google Search Engine is a complex process involving crawling, indexing, and ranking, where errors can occur.

It is important to understand that Google Search Console is a "low-memory, low-performance, low-priority system". Because Google dumps vast amounts of information into this free tool, it does not prioritize it for resources; consequently, there can be delays in reporting problems or updating solutions.

Setting Up: Domain vs. URL Prefix

When you start, you are presented with two choices: "Domain" and "URL prefix," and you should essentially use both.

- **Domain Property:** This links the root domain (e.g., example.com) and requires DNS verification.
- **URL Prefix Property:** This links a specific URL version (e.g., <https://www.google.com>).

You should connect both properties to get full data coverage. Start by verifying the **Domain Property** first because once that is verified, the URL prefix property will auto-verify.

Verification Process

To verify a Domain Property, you must add a specific record to your DNS settings:

1. **Get the Code:** Select the Domain property type and copy the provided TXT record.
2. **Access DNS:** Go to your hosting provider's "Zone Editor" or DNS management area.
3. **Add Record:** Create a new TXT record, paste the value from Google, and enter your domain name.
4. **TTL Settings:** Set the Time To Live (TTL) value to 300 (5 minutes) if possible to speed up propagation, though default values like 14400 are also acceptable.
5. **Verify:** Click verify in Search Console. If it fails immediately, wait a few minutes for the DNS to propagate.

Once the domain is verified, you can add the URL prefix (e.g., <https://www.delhibelly.site>), and it will verify automatically.

The Dashboard and Overview

When a site is first connected, you may see an empty dashboard or a clock icon indicating Google is processing data. For an established site, the "Overview" tab shows a snapshot of Performance, Indexing, Experience (speed/usability), and Enhancements.

It is crucial to distinguish between **Web Search Clicks** and **Total Traffic**:

- Search Console only counts clicks from Google Search results pages.
- It does not count internal navigation. If a user enters and browses 50 pages, Analytics will show 50 pageviews, but Search Console will show 1 click.

The Performance Tab

This is the most critical section for analysis. It provides four key metrics over a default 3-month period:

1. **Clicks:** How many times users clicked your result.
2. **Impressions:** How many times your URL was visible in search results.
3. **CTR (Click-Through Rate):** The percentage of impressions that resulted in clicks.
4. **Average Position:** The average ranking of your URLs. *Note: Do not obsess over average position as ranking for new, low-volume keywords can skew this number down.*

Filters and Comparisons:

- **Date Range:** You can filter by 24 hours, 7 days, or up to 16 months.
- **Comparisons:** You can compare periods (e.g., "Year Over Year" or specific months like June vs. July) to analyze seasonal trends.
- **Search Type:** Filter by Web, Image, Video, or News traffic.

Filtering Data: Queries, Pages, and Countries

You can filter data to answer specific questions:

- **Queries:** View which specific terms users are searching. You can filter by "Exact query" (e.g., just "Nidha's") or "Query containing" (e.g., any query with "cake").
- **Pages:** Paste a specific URL to see which queries that specific page ranks for.
- **Countries & Devices:** Analyze performance differences between regions (e.g., Canada vs. India) or devices (Desktop vs. Mobile).

Keywords vs. Queries

There is a distinction between what you target and what users type:

- **Keywords:** These are what SEOs target in their content (e.g., "Birthday Cakes").
- **Queries:** These are what users actually type into Google (e.g., "Healthy cake recipes," "Cakes near me").

You should use the "Queries" tab to find opportunities. If you see high impressions for "Healthy Cake" but have no dedicated page for it, you should create one.

Analyzing the Data Tables

The table below the graph allows you to sort by Clicks, Impressions, CTR, or Position.

- High impressions but low clicks indicate a potential opportunity (perhaps the position is low or the title isn't clicking).
- You can reverse engineer your success by clicking on a specific query to see which pages are ranking for it, or clicking a specific page to see which queries it ranks for.

Indexing Status

To quickly check how many pages Google has indexed, you can use the "site operator" in Google Search (searching [site:yourdomain.com](#)). This gives a ballpark number of indexed pages, which you can compare against your actual page count.

Do's and Don'ts

Do:

- **Connect both Property types:** You must connect both the **Domain Property** (e.g., [example.com](#)) and the **URL Prefix Property** (e.g., <https://www.example.com>) to get complete data and flexibility.
- **Treat GSC as a low-priority system:** Understand that GSC is a "low-memory, low-performance, low-priority system." Expect delays in data reporting and issue resolution updates.
- **Focus on Clicks and Impressions:** Prioritize these metrics over "Average Position," as the latter can be skewed by ranking low for irrelevant keywords.

- **Analyze specific queries:** Use filters to see exactly which user queries are triggering your pages to appear in search results.

- **Minimize TTL values during setup:** When verifying a domain, set the Time To Live (TTL) to a lower value (e.g., 300 seconds) if possible to speed up the propagation of DNS records.

Don't:

- **Don't rely on GSC for total traffic stats:** Do not confuse "Web Search Clicks" with total website visits. GSC counts clicks from Google Search results, not internal page navigation or traffic from other sources.

- **Don't ignore the "Query" vs. "Keyword" distinction:** Do not assume the query (what users type) is identical to your targeted keyword. You cannot control queries, but you can adapt your content to match them.

- **Don't assume immediate verification:** If domain verification fails initially, do not panic. DNS propagation can take time depending on your hosting provider.

What Needs to be Done

1. **Establish the Connection:** You need to act as the mediator between your website and Google by setting up the GSC account. This smooths out communication regarding crawling, indexing, and errors.

2. **Verify Ownership:** You must prove to Google that you own the website by adding specific records to your domain's DNS settings.

3. **Data Analysis:** regularly check the "Performance" tab to understand how your site performs in search, looking at Clicks, Impressions, CTR (Click-Through Rate), and Position.

4. **Filter Data for Insights:** You need to filter data by date, query, page, country, and device to answer specific questions (e.g., "Which queries bring traffic to my specific 'Birthday Cake' page?").

How to Do It

1. Setting up the Domain Property (The Primary Step)

- **Select Property Type:** In GSC, select "Domain" (not URL Prefix initially). Enter your domain without protocols (e.g., delhibelly.site).

- **Get the Verification Code:** GSC will provide a TXT record value. Copy this code.

- **Access DNS Settings:** Log into your hosting or domain registrar panel (often cPanel). Look for "Zone Editor" or "DNS Management".

- **Add the Record:**

- Click "Add Record" and select **TXT** as the type.

- Paste the value copied from GSC into the record field.

- **Name Field:** Enter your domain name exactly as it is.
- **TTL Field:** Set this to **300** (5 minutes) if your host allows, or leave it at the default (e.g., 14400).
- Save the record.
- **Verify:** Return to GSC and click "Verify." If it fails immediately, wait a few minutes or up to an hour for propagation.

2. Setting up the URL Prefix Property

- Once the Domain Property is verified, go back to "Add Property."
- Select "URL Prefix" and enter the full URL (e.g., <https://www.delhibelly.site>).
- It should auto-verify because you have already verified the domain.

3. Analyzing Performance

- Navigate to the **Performance** tab (or "Google Search Results").
- **To find specific keyword performance:** Click on "+ New" in the filter bar, select **Query**, and choose "Exact query" or "Query containing" to filter for specific terms (e.g., "Nidha's").
- **To analyze a specific page:** Click on "+ New," select **Page**, and paste the exact URL of the page you want to analyze to see which queries it ranks for.

Common Mistakes and Solutions

Mistake 1: Only verifying one property type.

- **Issue:** Users often only verify the URL prefix or the Domain property, limiting their data view or future flexibility.
- **Solution:** Verify the Domain property first via DNS, then add the URL prefix property. The second one will auto-verify based on the first.

Mistake 2: Confusing "Keywords" with "Queries."

- **Issue:** SEOs target "Keywords," but users search "Queries." You might target "Birthday Cakes," but users might find you searching for "Healthy Cake Recipes".
- **Solution:** Check the **Queries** tab to see what users *actually* search for. If you see high impressions for a query like "Healthy Cake" but have no content for it, create a new page specifically for that topic.

Mistake 3: Misinterpreting "Average Position."

- **Issue:** Users worry when their average position drops (e.g., from 5 to 10). However, this might happen because you are starting to rank for new keywords at position 80, dragging the average down.
- **Solution:** Ignore the aggregate "Average Position." Focus on **Impressions** (visibility) and **Clicks**. A lower average position with higher impressions is often a good sign of growth.

Mistake 4: Discrepancy between Server Logs/Analytics and GSC.

- **Issue:** A client may claim 25,000 visitors, but GSC shows only 6,000 clicks.
- **Solution:** Understand that GSC records the *entry* click from Google. If a user clicks once (1 GSC click) and then browses 50 pages on the site, Analytics sees 50 pageviews, but GSC still sees 1 click. Educate stakeholders on this difference.

Mistake 5: Panic over data delay.

- **Issue:** You fix a problem, but GSC doesn't update, leading you to try fixing it again unnecessarily.
- **Solution:** Remember GSC is a "low-performance" system. Data is dumped by Google and processed with a delay. Be patient with updates.